



PANCAKE TORTOISE
Malacochersus tornieri
Found in E. Africa, this omnivorous species inhabits rocky areas. Its flat shape allows it to hide in cracks.

18 cm
7 in

growth rings on the carapace of juveniles



1.2 m
4 ft

large forelimbs

ALDABRA GIANT TORTOISE
Aldabrachelys gigantea
Restricted to the Aldabra atoll in the Indian Ocean, this large herbivore is able to drink through its nostrils.



19 cm
7½ in

HERMANN'S TORTOISE
Testudo hermanni

This herbivorous species inhabits dry forests of coastal Italy and S. France. It hibernates during the cold winter months.



flattened scute

GALAPAGOS TORTOISE
Chelonoidis nigra
One of the world's largest tortoises, this mainly vegetarian species has 11 subspecies, from different islands in the Galapagos archipelago.

1.2 m
4 ft

jaw with sharp cutting edge for eating vegetation



28 cm
11 in

STEPPE TORTOISE
Agrionemys horsfieldii
A herbivore from the dry deserts and steppes of C. Asia, this species escapes the daytime heat by sheltering in burrows.

TUATARA

Superficially like a lizard, New Zealand's tuatara belongs to a far more ancient order of reptiles. Its closest relatives became extinct 100 million years ago.

The tuatara has many anatomical features that set it apart from lizards. Most striking are its wedge-shaped "teeth" – actually serrations of the jawbone. The upper jaw has a double row that fits over a single row on the lower jaw.

Tuatara are very long lived, but are vulnerable to introduced ground predators. Inhabiting coastal forests, they are active at low body temperatures and emerge from their burrows at night to hunt for invertebrates, and birds' eggs and chicks. Males are territorial and nesting is communal. Eggs take up to four years to form and are incubated for 11 to 16 months before hatching. Incubation temperature determines the sex of the hatchlings.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	REPTILIA
ORDER	RHYNCHOCEPHALIA
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	1

TUATARA

Often portrayed as "living fossils", the Sphenodontidae are modern representatives of reptiles that coexisted with dinosaurs. This primitive species is found only on offshore islands of New Zealand.



stout tail

TUATARA
Sphenodon punctatus
This reptile has clawed limbs to dig burrows. It can shed its tail to escape predators. The male uses its dorsal crest for display.

60 cm
23½ in

powerful clawed limbs